7.3 Proving That a Quadrilateral Is a Parallelogram

Name _____ Period ____ Date _____

Geometry 7.3 · Student sheet

I can…

- name the theorem that proves a quadrilateral is a parallelogram.
- find values of variables that make a quadrilateral a parallelogram.
- use slope, distance, or midpoints to show a quadrilateral in the coordinate plane is a parallelogram.

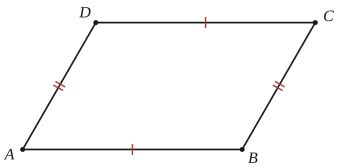
Part 1 · Build it: does it have to be a parallelogram?

Connect two strips of one length and two of another, with equal strips **opposite** each other. Can you make a quadrilateral that is NOT a parallelogram?

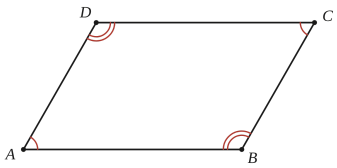
Now put the equal strips **next to** each other. What shape do you get?

Is it a parallelogram? Write yes or not enough information, and the reason.

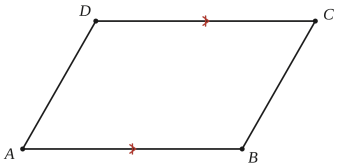
1.



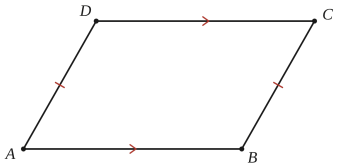
2.



3.



4.



Part 2 · Notes: fill in the blanks

Both pairs of opposite sides are _____ (definition).

Both pairs of opposite sides are _____.

Both pairs of opposite angles are _____.

One pair of opposite sides is _____ and _____.

The diagonals _____ each other.

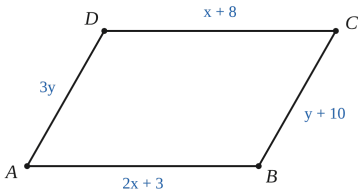
Coordinates: use _____ (parallel), _____ (congruent), or _____ of the diagonals (bisect).

Part 3 · Examples (work them with the class)

Example 1

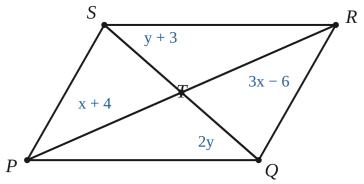
For what values of x and y is ABCD a parallelogram?

AB = 2x + 3, DC = x + 8, AD = 3y, BC = y + 10



Example 2

The diagonals of quadrilateral PQRS meet at T. PT = x + 4, TR = 3x − 6, QT = 2y, and TS = y + 3. For what values of x and y is PQRS a parallelogram?



Example 3

Show that A(−3, 3), B(1, 4), C(3, 0), and D(−1, −1) are the vertices of a parallelogram.

Example 4

In quadrilateral WXYZ, $\overline{WX} \cong \overline{YZ}$ and $\overline{WZ} \parallel \overline{XY}$. Is WXYZ a parallelogram?

Part 4 · Partner practice

Partner 1

In quadrilateral ABCD, m∠A = (4x − 10)° and m∠C = (2x + 30)°. For what value of x could ABCD be a parallelogram (with m∠B = m∠D)?

Partner 2

Is EFGH with E(0, 0), F(4, 1), G(5, 4), and H(1, 3) a parallelogram? Use midpoints.